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FIT HUB

• HIT • DAY 9

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# Tabata Training

4 Minutes That Change Everything

Day 9 of 30 | High-Intensity Interval Training

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- 20/10 Tabata protocol explained
- 3 full Tabata blocks
- Effort scoring system

## 01 | The Origin of Tabata — From Ice Hockey to the World

In 1996, Japanese scientist Dr. Izumi Tabata published a study comparing two groups: one doing 60 minutes of moderate cardio, the other doing 4-minute Tabata intervals. After 6 weeks, the Tabata group had improved both aerobic capacity (VO<sub>2</sub> max) AND anaerobic capacity. The moderate cardio group improved aerobic capacity only. **4 minutes beat 60 minutes** — in half the categories.

The protocol is brutally simple: **20 seconds maximum effort, 10 seconds rest, repeated 8 times = 4 minutes**. One round. One exercise. Total devastation. When done correctly, it is one of the most effective fat-burning and conditioning tools in existence.

| Protocol       | Work   | Rest      | Rounds | Total Time  | Intensity      |
|----------------|--------|-----------|--------|-------------|----------------|
| HIIT (Day 2)   | 30 sec | 30 sec    | 3–4    | 20 min      | 80–90% max HR  |
| Tabata (today) | 20 sec | 10 sec    | 8      | 4 min/block | 90–100% max HR |
| EMOM (Day 15)  | X reps | Remainder | 10–20  | 10–20 min   | 75–90% max HR  |

### ■ INFO — 10 Seconds Is Not Enough Rest. That Is the Point.

The 10-second rest in Tabata is deliberately insufficient. Your body cannot recover fully, so each round starts with accumulated fatigue. This is what forces adaptation in both energy systems simultaneously. If 10 seconds feels like enough — you are not going hard enough on the 20-second intervals.

## 02 | How to Execute Tabata Correctly

| Stage               | What to Do                                                     | Common Mistake                                        |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Warm-up             | At least 5 minutes. Tabata without warm-up risks muscle tears. | Skipping warm-up to "save time"                       |
| Round 1–2           | Establish pace. Hold back 10% — you have 6 more rounds.        | Going 100% on round 1 and dying by round 5            |
| Round 3–6           | This is where the work happens. Maintain form under fatigue.   | Letting form break down to chase more reps            |
| Round 7–8           | Empty the tank. These rounds should feel near-impossible.      | Stopping early or taking extra rest                   |
| Rest between blocks | 60–90 seconds minimum before the next 4-minute block.          | Starting the next block before HR drops below 130 bpm |

### ■■ WARNING — Tabata Is Not for Every Day

Tabata taxes the central nervous system heavily. Maximum 2–3 Tabata sessions per week, never on consecutive days. Today is Day 9. Your next Tabata session will be Day 24 (Peak Phase). Between now and then, HIIT and EMOM formats provide sufficient intensity.

## 03 | Day 9 Workout — 3-Block Tabata Session

**Format:** 20 sec max effort / 10 sec rest × 8 rounds = 4 min per block | **Blocks:** 3 | **Rest between blocks:** 90 sec | **Total time:** ~25 min | **Equipment:** None

| WARM-UP (5 min — mandatory for Tabata) |          |                                           |
|----------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------|
| Exercise                               | Duration | Notes                                     |
| Easy jog in place                      | 90 sec   | Gradually increase pace                   |
| Leg swings + arm swings                | 60 sec   | 30 sec each                               |
| Deep squat hold                        | 30 sec   | Hold bottom position, breathe             |
| Hip circles                            | 30 sec   | Both directions                           |
| Explosive jumping jacks                | 60 sec   | Build to 80% intensity — prime the system |
| 10-sec sprint in place                 | 30 sec   | 3 × (10 sec hard / 10 sec easy)           |

| BLOCK A — Lower Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min) |            |             |                  |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------|------------------|-----------|
| Round                                                            | Exercise   | Target Reps | Easier Option    | Your Reps |
| 1–2                                                              | Jump Squat | 12–15       | Bodyweight Squat | ___ / ___ |
| 3–4                                                              | Jump Squat | 10–13       | Bodyweight Squat | ___ / ___ |
| 5–6                                                              | Jump Squat | 9–12        | Bodyweight Squat | ___ / ___ |
| 7–8                                                              | Jump Squat | MAX         | Bodyweight Squat | ___ / ___ |

| BLOCK B — Upper Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min) |          |             |               |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------|---------------|-----------|
| Round                                                            | Exercise | Target Reps | Easier Option | Your Reps |
| 1–2                                                              | Push-Up  | 10–12       | Knee Push-Up  | ___ / ___ |
| 3–4                                                              | Push-Up  | 8–10        | Knee Push-Up  | ___ / ___ |
| 5–6                                                              | Push-Up  | 7–9         | Knee Push-Up  | ___ / ___ |
| 7–8                                                              | Push-Up  | MAX         | Knee Push-Up  | ___ / ___ |

| BLOCK C — Full Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min) |          |             |                  |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------|------------------|-----------|
| Round                                                           | Exercise | Target Reps | Easier Option    | Your Reps |
| 1–2                                                             | Burpee   | 6–8         | Step-Back Burpee | ___ / ___ |
| 3–4                                                             | Burpee   | 5–7         | Step-Back Burpee | ___ / ___ |
| 5–6                                                             | Burpee   | 5–6         | Step-Back Burpee | ___ / ___ |
| 7–8                                                             | Burpee   | MAX         | Step-Back Burpee | ___ / ___ |

■ INFO — Effort Score System

After each block rate your effort 1–10. Block A target: 8–9/10. Block B: 8–9/10. Block C: 9–10/10. If you scored below 7 on any block, you held back too much. If you could not finish round 7 or 8, that is exactly right.

04 | Cool-Down + Tabata Quick Reference

| COOL-DOWN (4 min)                      |          |
|----------------------------------------|----------|
| Exercise                               | Duration |
| Walk in place — slow HR down           | 90 sec   |
| Standing quad stretch (each leg)       | 30 sec   |
| Hip flexor lunge stretch (each side)   | 30 sec   |
| Seated forward fold                    | 45 sec   |
| Lying spinal twist (each side)         | 30 sec   |
| Deep breathing — 4 in / 4 hold / 6 out | 45 sec   |

05 | Tabata Quick Reference Card

| Rule                | Guideline                                                                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Protocol            | 20 sec max effort / 10 sec rest × 8 rounds = 4 min per block.                       |
| Intensity required  | 90–100% max heart rate during the 20-sec work intervals.                            |
| Frequency           | Max 2–3 times per week. Never two days in a row.                                    |
| Minimum warm-up     | 5 minutes mandatory — Tabata without warm-up risks injury.                          |
| Rest between blocks | 60–90 seconds. Let heart rate drop below 140 bpm.                                   |
| Number of blocks    | Beginners: 2 blocks. Intermediate: 3 blocks. Advanced: 4–6 blocks.                  |
| Exercise selection  | Compound, full-body movements only — burpee, squat jump, push-up, mountain climber. |
| Know when to stop   | Dizziness, chest pain, or unable to maintain any form = stop immediately.           |

06 | Day 9 Self-Check Question

Complete before Day 10.

*"In which of the 3 blocks did you feel the biggest drop in reps from round 1 to round 8? What does that tell you about your weakest energy system — and what exercise will you use to target it this week?"*

Your answer:

Next up — Day 10:  
 Flexibility Fundamentals — Mobility for Athletes

Community & support:  
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